

WHY MBA: GLOBAL TRENDS

MALE VS. FEMALE

	% of women	% of men
Primarily for education	8.21	7.60
To boost salary	9.38	10.12
To build professional network	14.35	15.58
To enable career change	11.89	12.62
To improve career prospects	26.97	24.29
To learn new skills	19.93	19.67
To start own business	7.95	9.30
Other	1.32	0.82

SOURCE: QS TOPMBA.COM—WORLD MBA TOUR APPLICANT SURVEY 2007

CHANGE IN PERSPECTIVE

Motivations (in per cent)	2005-06	2006-07
Improve career prospects	73%	69%
Learn new skills	57%	54%
To build a professional network	42%	41%
Enable a career change	39%	34%
Boost salary	30%	27%
Start own business	25%	24%
Primarily for the education	26%	21%
Other	2%	2%

SOURCE: TOPMBA.COM APPLICANT RESEARCH 2005-06 AND 2006-07

managing director, Saint Gobain Glass India Ltd, says, "A large number of us touch base with engineering in some form or the other."

In a survey, conducted by QS topmba.com, an international think-tank tracking MBA trends, over 6,000 aspiring MBAs including a sizeable sample from India responded to the question "what would be the key factor behind their choice of school?" The first was the school's reputation followed by the success of its career placement office and the return on financial investment. The set of considerations for any aspirant, before he or she decides to go for an MBA, reveals the survey, included improvement in career prospects, the opportunity to learn new skills, building a professional network, enabling career change, boosting pay package, starting one's own business and for general education.

Financial returns were not on top of everyone's mind but financial viability was. This only mirrored students' concerns about the hefty financial liabilities that they incur to pay for their degrees. Aspiring MBAs are looking for upward mobility and willing to put a lot at stake even though with barely 10 per cent of the accredited B-schools delivering anything remotely desirable. This has bust many a dreams.

Richa Aggarwal, 22, decided to go for an MBA instead of doing M.Sc after her B.Sc from Bareilly. "I wanted to stand on my own feet and a good placement with a good pay package," she says. That took her all the way to MS, Dehradun, for a two-year MBA programme. Average salaries during placement season here didn't touch any astronomical figure though. The highest went up to Rs 6 lakh per annum whereas Aggarwal is currently drawing Rs 1.2 lakh as a marketing coordinator in a Delhi-based firm. That's hardly the MBA dream that a majority of aspirants would leave their cushy jobs for.

Out of the 2,000-odd B-schools in India, only about 50-75 are able to get decent placements for their students. Even among these, only the top will deliver the dream salaries. In fact, some students in the C-category

STUDENT'S TAKE



Better career and money aren't mutually exclusive; one should not come at the cost of the other.

AKSHAY MAHESHWARI
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per cent from commerce and close to 10 per cent from law and other streams. How many of these would go back to doing what they were, is anybody's guess. Although, B. Santhanam, an IIT-IIM alumnus and president, Flat Glass, South Asia and